

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Who is spreading rumors and creating a scandal?



Learning Outcome

Explain customs and appropriate behavior at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Can Do Statements

- I can stress new information.
- I can talk about strange events.
- I can talk about actions related to an event.

Ask your partner:

- Do you like to talk about rumors? Why or why not?
- What are some rumors that you have heard recently?
- Why do you think some people enjoy spreading rumors and talking about scandals?





Let's Explore!

Ferdinand shares a **rumor*** with Janet.

* A "rumor" is an interesting story that may or may not be true and that quickly spreads from person to person.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Ferdinand?
- Ferdinand:** Janet! We're finally connected. Thanks for calling back.
- Janet:** I've been worried. Are you all right?
- Ferdinand:** Calm down, Janet. I'm fine. I only have a minute's privacy on this phone. I was reviewing public response to the fashion show ... and by complete coincidence, I came across a terrible, disturbing rumor. Just like that - and out of the blue. I hope it won't lead to a real scandal. I'll admit it needs to be checked out.
- Janet:** Go on.
- Ferdinand:** The writer claims that Holly's clothing is outsourced to South East Asia and child labor is used in their factories.
- Janet:** What? Ferdinand, how credible did this source seem?
- Ferdinand:** I have no idea. It seems to have come out of nowhere. There isn't a lot of information to back it up. The claim is based on hearsay. But Holly's is the only company that is mentioned by the writer.
- Janet:** Who is the writer? We need to figure out who she is and ...
- Ferdinand:** Janet ... I'll ask around. The writer's whole purpose was to call people to action, starting with petitions and boycotts.
- Janet:** This is too weird. Ferdinand, the truth on this matter needs to be investigated. Facts and evidence are needed above all.
- Ferdinand:** I agree. By good chance I know a reporter in Rio with great connections.
- Janet:** Good. Finances are not to be considered when dealing with this matter. Can I count on you, Ferdinand?
- Ferdinand:** Absolutely. Thanks Janet. I'm on to it. I won't let you down.





Let's Practice!

It's important to check out the facts!

Instructions: Find the phrasal verb from each sentence in the wordsearch below.

1. I came across a terribly disturbing rumor.
2. I will admit we need to check out this information.
3. It seems to come out of nowhere.
4. We need to figure out who she is.
5. There is not enough information to back up the story we heard.
6. I'll ask around.
7. Finances are not to be considered when deal with this matter.
8. Can I count on you?
9. I won't let you down.



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about a strange event. What words should we use?

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the words from the word bank. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

by complete coincidence / by good chance / weird / out of the blue /
hearsay / come out of nowhere

1. I was reviewing public responses to the fashion show ... and _____, I came across a terribly disturbing rumor.
2. Just like that - _____.
3. I have no idea. It seems to have _____. There's isn't a lot of information to back it up.
4. The claim is based on _____.
5. This is too _____.
6. I agree. _____, I know a reporter in Rio with great connections.





Extension Activity

Research a scandal.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Using the internet, research a recent scandal that happened in your country or somewhere else.
- Write a paragraph that summarizes the story.
- Summarize the story in your own words.
- Exchange paragraphs with another student.
- Comment on how much of the story you think is true.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about strange events.

☐ ☐

I use phrasal verbs.

☐ ☐

I talk about facts, ideas and situations.

☐ ☐

I research a scandal.

☐ ☐

I write a summary paragraph.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **by complete coincidence** (expression): in a way that is unlikely and surprising
e.g. By complete coincidence, I came across a terribly disturbing rumor.
- **came out of nowhere** (expression): to happen by surprise
e.g. It seems it came out of nowhere.
- **out of the blue** (expression): completely unexpected
e.g. Just like that - out of the blue.
- **hearsay** (noun): information that you have heard but do not know to be true
e.g. The claim is based on hearsay.
- **weird** (adjective): strange
e.g. This is too weird.
- **by good chance** (expression): it's lucky that
e.g. By good chance I know a reporter in Rio with great connections.





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs consist of a verb and one or more prepositions. They are common, especially in spoken English. The meaning of phrasal verbs is often completely different from the meaning of the verb alone. Phrasal verbs can either be separable or inseparable.

Separable phrasal verbs consist of two parts. They **always** require an object.

The object of a phrasal verb can go either between the verb and the preposition or after the preposition.

Examples:

*I **figured out** what happened.*

*I **figured it out**.*

If the object of the sentence is a pronoun, it must go between the two parts of the phrasal verb.

Example:

*I **figured it out**.* > NOT > *I **figured out** it.*

Some phrasal verbs are inseparable, so the verb **must** be directly followed by its preposition. Otherwise, the meaning of the phrasal verb will be incorrect.

Some inseparable phrasal verbs never use an object.

Examples:

*Can I **count on** you?*

*I **checked out** the matter.*

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
to come across	to find by chance
to check out	to check something to get more information
to come out	to appear
to count on	to trust that someone will do as expected
to back up	to provide support
to figure out	to find a solution





Learning Points

Examples:

- *I came across a terribly disturbing rumor.*
- *I'll admit it needs to be checked out.*
- *It seems to have come out of nowhere.*
- *Can I count on you?*
- *We need to figure out who she is.*
- *There's isn't a lot of information to back it up.*

Stressing New Information

Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or "beat".

Word stress is emphasis on **one syllable** within a **word**.

Sentence stress is emphasis on **certain words** within a **sentence**.

Most sentences have two basic types of words:

Content Words

- Content words are the important or key words in a sentence. They provide the meaning of the sentence.

Structure Words

- Structure words are not important words. They are small words that you use to make the sentence correct.

When you want to stress **new information**, you use different intonation and stress on the "new" word or idea. Usually, the stressed words in a sentence are the nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs.

Sometimes, you can choose to stress other types of words to show that you are adding new information or when talking about a strange event.

Examples:

- *You won't **believe** what happened!*
- ***Child labor** is used in their factories!*

